

OTO 2 · YOU'RE NOT ALONE WITH THIS

Your Private Crochet Coach™

Your welcome guide: how to reach your coach, how to send a photo that gets a fast answer, and the 10 most common stitching problems — with the cause and the fix for each.

- How your access works — chat line, reviews, live calls, DM fast lane
- The 10 most common crochet problems, solved
- How to send a photo that gets you a useful answer
- What to do before your first question

What's Inside

Start with "How Your Access Works" — it takes two minutes and saves you from wondering.

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How Your Access Works

"A video can play back for you at two in the morning, but it can't watch you. This is the part of your purchase that can."

Your coaching access has four parts. Use whichever fits the moment — you don't need to wait for the "right" one.

1. Your private chat line

This is your direct line to a real crochet coach — not a chatbot, not a public forum. Send a photo of exactly where you're stuck, any hour, any day, and you'll get a specific answer with the actual fix, usually within a few hours. This line is active for 60 days from today.

2. Unlimited pattern-check reviews

Before you commit to another 20 rows on a piece you're not sure about, send it in. You'll get told exactly what to adjust — whether that's your gauge, your stitch count, or a step you may have misread. Use this as many times as you need for the next 30 days.

3. Live group troubleshooting calls

Four live calls over the next month, where questions get solved out loud in real time — often the fastest way to understand a fix, because you can see it explained, not just read it. Every call is recorded, so if you miss one, you can catch the replay.

4. Your DM fast lane

Questions sent through your fast lane get answered same-day, ahead of the general inbox — this is your priority line for anything that's stopping you from finishing a piece right now.

✓ **Before your first question.** Have your pattern name/round number and a clear photo ready (see the photo guide later in this book) — the faster your coach can see exactly what you see, the faster you get a fix that actually works.

The 10 Most Common Crochet Problems — and the Fix

Before you message your coach, check here first — there's a good chance your exact issue and its fix are already below.

1 My hands cramp and my stitches are too tight

Cause: gripping the hook like a pencil too rigidly and wrapping yarn around your fist instead of your fingers, which forces every stitch to fight your own grip.

Fix: loosen your hold on the hook — it should rest lightly, not be squeezed — and wrap the working yarn once around your index or pinky finger instead of your whole hand. Take a 2-minute break every 15-20 minutes; tension almost always gets worse as your hand tires, not better.

2 My finished cap is too big or too small for the pattern's size

Cause: your personal tension is tighter or looser than the pattern designer's, so the same stitch count comes out a different size on your hook.

Fix: before starting a new pattern, crochet a small test swatch and measure it against the pattern's gauge note. If your swatch is smaller than stated, go up a hook size; if it's larger, go down one. This one check prevents almost every "wrong size" problem before it happens.

3 My cap's ears or decorations don't line up evenly

Cause: placing each ear or decoration by eye instead of counting the exact same row and stitch position on both sides.

Fix: place a stitch marker at the exact stitch where you attach the first ear, count how many stitches and rows that is from a fixed point (like the center back), then count the identical number for the second ear. Never eyeball symmetry — always count it.

4 My stitch count keeps drifting up or down as I go

Cause: an accidental extra stitch worked into the same spot twice, or a stitch skipped — most often at the start or end of a round where it's easy to lose your place.

Fix: place a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round and count your total stitches before moving to the next round, every single time, not just when something looks off. Catching a miscount within one round is a 10-second fix; catching it five rounds later means unraveling all five.

5 The bottom edge of my cap curls inward

Cause: a foundation chain or first round worked too tightly, which pulls the edge into a curl the same way a too-tight elastic does.

Fix: work your foundation round one hook size larger than the rest of the piece, or simply relax your tension for just that first round. If the cap is already finished, wetting it lightly and laying it flat to dry (blocking) will usually relax the curl on its own.

6 My cap comes out too tall or too shallow — it doesn't sit right on the head

Cause: starting the crown decreases too early or too late, usually from miscounting how many rounds you'd worked before that point.

Fix: measure your piece flat against a soft tape measure at the specific round the pattern lists as a checkpoint — most patterns tell you the expected diameter at a given round. If yours doesn't match, add or remove a round before starting decreases, not after.

7 My color changes look messy or yarn tails show through

Cause: switching colors at a random point in the round (so the join shows on the visible side) and not weaving ends in far enough.

Fix: always join a new color at the same spot each round — usually the back center, where the join is least visible. Weave each tail through at least 3-4 inches of stitches on the wrong side, going in one direction and then doubling back, so it can't work loose.

8 My final join (where the last round meets the first) looks bulky or leaves a visible step

Cause: using a standard slip-stitch join, which naturally creates a small raised step where the round closes.

Fix: switch to an invisible join: cut the yarn leaving a 6-inch tail, thread it on a yarn needle, and stitch it through the top of the first stitch of the round mimicking the shape of a normal stitch, then weave the tail in. It looks seamless because it mimics the stitch pattern instead of stacking on top of it.

9 Small holes or gaps show up right where the pattern decreases stitches

Cause: using a decrease method that leaves a visible gap, or working the decrease with uneven tension compared to the surrounding stitches.

Fix: use an invisible decrease (working into the front loops only of the two stitches being combined, rather than through both full stitches) and keep your tension consistent right through the decrease stitch — most gaps come from unconsciously loosening up right at the tricky part.

10 My rounds seem to spiral and the pattern looks slightly off-center or lopsided

Cause: working in a continuous spiral without marking where each round starts, so increases/decreases drift out of alignment over many rounds.

Fix: move a stitch marker up into the first stitch of every new round without exception. If the drift is already noticeable on a piece in progress, switch that piece to join-and-chain rounds instead of spiral rounds — it resets your reference point every round instead of letting it drift.

✓ **Still stuck after checking here?** That's exactly what your chat line is for. Send a photo (see the next section for how) and describe which of these 10 feels closest — it helps your coach get you a fix faster.

BEFORE YOU MESSAGE

How to Send a Photo for Review

A good photo gets you a specific answer in one message. A blurry, far-away photo usually means a back-and-forth to figure out what you're even asking about.

Lighting

Take the photo near a window in daylight, not under a yellow lamp at night if you can help it — yellow indoor lighting hides exactly the kind of tension and color issues your coach needs to see. If it's late and daylight isn't an option, a white ceiling light beats a lamp.

Angle

Get close enough that individual stitches are clearly visible — not a photo of the whole cap from across the room. If the issue is in one specific spot (a gap, a tight row, a misaligned decrease), photograph that spot filling most of the frame, then take a second wider photo so your coach can see where that spot sits in the whole piece.

What to show



Send these 3 photos together when possible

The full piece, laid flat, so your coach sees the overall shape

Wide shot

A close-up of the exact spot you're stuck on or unhappy with

Macro shot

The piece still on your hook, if you're mid-row and confused about a stitch

In-progress

Along with the photos, tell your coach the pattern name and the round or row number you're on — that context turns a 10-minute guessing game into a 1-message answer.

FAQ

Frequently Asked Questions

What you're probably wondering in your first week.

How fast will I get an answer?

Usually within a few hours on your private chat line. Your DM fast lane questions are answered same-day, ahead of the general inbox.

Can I ask more than one question at a time?

Yes — send everything you're stuck on in one message with a photo for each issue if you have more than one. That's often faster than sending them one at a time.

What if my question isn't about a mistake — I just want feedback on a finished piece?

That's exactly what your pattern-check reviews are for. Send the finished (or in-progress) piece and you'll get told what's working and what to adjust before you start your next one.

Do I need to attend the live calls to benefit from this OTO?

No — every call is recorded, so you can watch the replay on your own schedule if the live time doesn't work for you.

What happens after my 60 days are up?

Your chat line access covers the full 60 days from today. Use the guarantee in your purchase confirmation if you haven't gotten at least 8 personal answers in that window.

You're not doing this alone anymore.

Save this guide. The next time you're stuck at 11pm, check the 10 problems first — then send a photo.

Keep building

Once you're consistently finishing pieces, the next step is turning first-time buyers into repeat ones — that's The Repeat Buyer Engine™.

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